



◆ INDEPENDENT UNIVERSITY, BANGLADESH ◆

DEPARTMENT OF PUBLIC HEALTH
HEALTH AND SOCIETY · WORLD MENTAL HEALTH DAY 2026

From Being Heard *to Creating Change*

Lived experiences heard: real voices, real change.



AWARENESS POSTER & LEAFLET

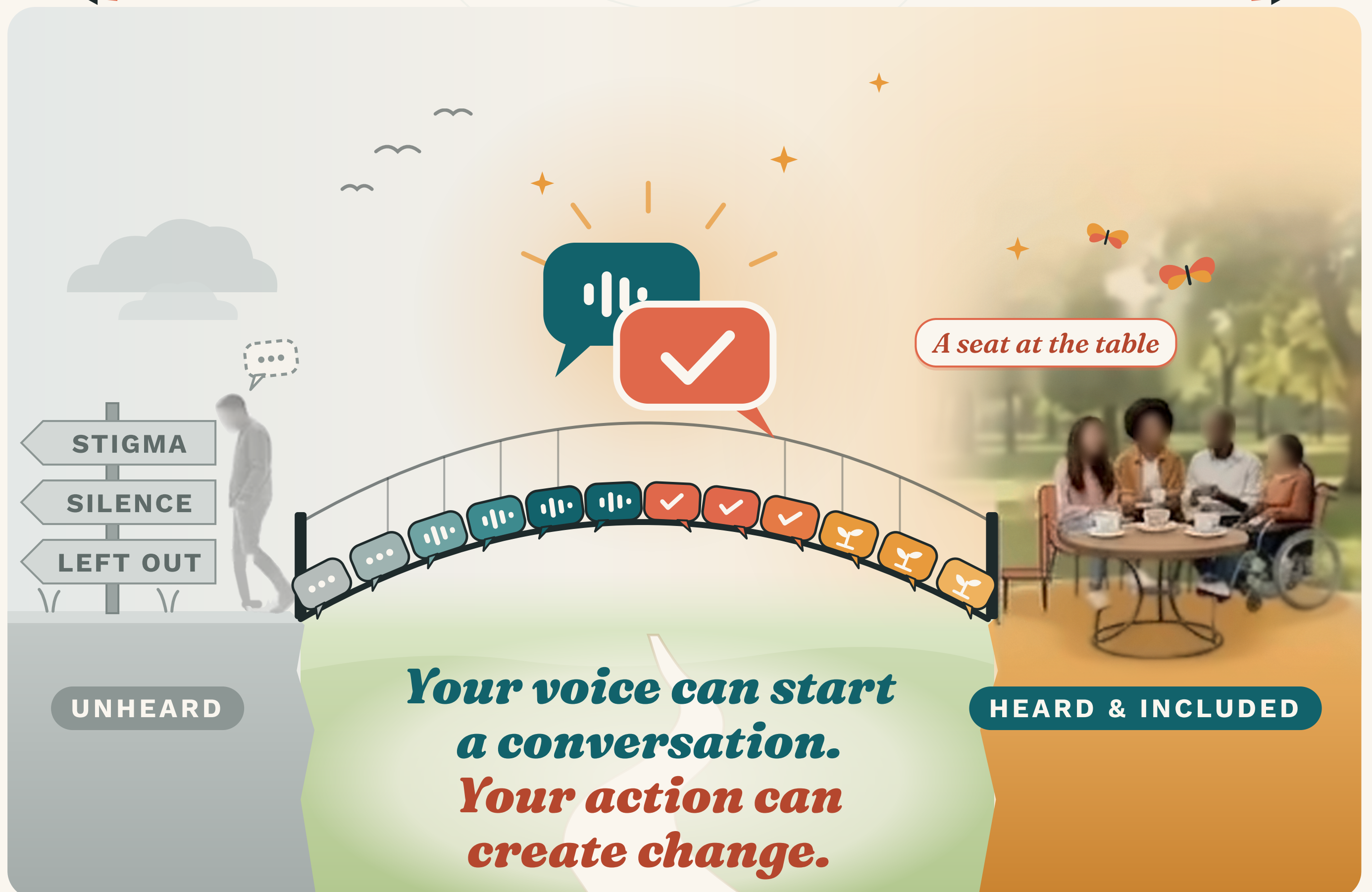
GROUP MEMBERS

Group 12

- 1 (G-12)-Shoada
- 2 (G-12)-Muna
- 3 (G-12)-Mahee

From Being Heard to Creating Change

Lived experiences heard: real voices, real change.



HOW BEING HEARD BECOMES CHANGE

OUR FOCUS



Speak

Share your thoughts and ideas.



Listen

Hear other people out before you judge.



Act

Do one small thing, with others.



Create change

Small actions add up to less stigma and better support.

Join the conversation.
Start with one small step:



Offer peer support



Challenge stigma



Check in on a friend

JOIN THE CONVERSATION

Be a part of it.

*Your voice can start a conversation.
Your action can create change.*

My small step this week

Work together and take small, meaningful steps. Tick one or more, and try them in the next 7 days.

- ☐ **Check in on a friend**
Send a message: "How are you, really?"
- ☐ **Listen without judging**
Let someone finish before you reply.
- ☐ **Share an idea or concern**
In class, at home or with a friend.
- ☐ **Challenge stigma**
Speak up about hurtful words or jokes.
- ☐ **Offer peer support**
Go with someone when they seek help.
- ☐ **Include others**
Ask the quiet person in the group for their view.

MY OWN STEP

DATE I DID IT _____



Better together: tell a friend which step you chose, and check in on each other's steps next week.

IF YOU NEED TO TALK

Where to find support

Reaching out is a strength. You don't have to go through it alone.



Someone you trust

A friend, family member, teacher or mentor.



Your university counselling service

Confidential support for students. Ask your department office or advisor where to go.



Shastho Batayon · health helpline

16263

Government health call centre, 24 hours.



In an emergency

999

National Emergency Service, 24 hours.

Share with care

Every story is different: share with consent, listen with respect. Never pass on someone's story without their permission. One person's experience doesn't speak for everyone.

When to check in

Someone seems withdrawn, low or not themselves for a while? Ask gently, listen, and help them reach support. If they talk about not wanting to live, stay with them and get help straight away.

#RealVoicesRealChange

World Mental Health Day 2026

Prepared by Group 12: Shoada, Muna, Mahee · Health and Society

Department of Public Health
Independent University, Bangladesh

◆ IUB · WORLD MENTAL HEALTH DAY 2026 ◆

From Being Heard to Creating Change



*Lived experiences heard:
real voices, real change.*

***Your voice can start a conversation.
Your action can create change.***



Speak



Listen



Understand



Act



Change



**Department of Public Health
Independent University, Bangladesh**
Group 12 · Health and Society

Five steps anyone can take

What is lived experience?

What a person has been through themselves: living with a mental health condition, seeking care, recovering, supporting someone they love, or facing barriers to help.

Why being heard matters

People who have lived it know what actually helps. When their voices are heard and included, support gets better and stigma gets smaller.

“Nothing about us, without us.”

People with lived experience belong in the decisions that affect them.

1 Speak

Don't be afraid to share your ideas and concerns.

TRY THIS

- ◆ Choose someone you trust and a quiet moment.
- ◆ Start small: “I’ve been feeling…” or “I’ve noticed…”
- ◆ You decide what to share, and how much.

2 Listen

Respect other people's opinions and experience.

TRY THIS

- ◆ Give your full attention and put the phone away.
- ◆ Don't interrupt, judge or rush to fix things.
- ◆ Thank them for trusting you.

3 Understand

Hear from different perspectives and identify what needs to change.

TRY THIS

- ◆ Ask: “What would really help you?”
- ◆ Remember that one person's story doesn't speak for everyone.
- ◆ Notice the barriers: stigma, silence, cost, distance.

Words matter when you listen

SAY

“I'm here for you.”
“Take your time.”
“Thank you for telling me.”

AVOID

“Just get over it.”
“Others have it worse.”
“It's all in your head.”

4 Act

Work together and take small, meaningful steps.

TRY THIS

- ◆ Check in on a friend this week.
- ◆ Offer peer support, or go with someone to get help.
- ◆ Include people in decisions that affect them.

5 Create change

Small actions can create a better community.

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

- ◆ Less stigma, more understanding.
- ◆ Better support that fits real lives.
- ◆ Dignity, respect and belonging for everyone.

***Your voice can start a conversation.
Your action can create change.***

**Join the conversation —
be a part of it.**

Speak › Listen › Understand › Act › **Change**



From Being Heard to Creating Change

Date: _____ Place: _____ Tested by: _____

AUDIENCE (STEP 1)**Demographics:** IUB students, 18–25, all departments.**Lifestyles:** classes, exams, group work, phones and social media.**Values:** friendship, fairness, being respected and included.**HOW TO RUN IT (STEP 3)**

Show the A4 draft to **10 students** who have not seen it. Let each look for **30 seconds**, then take it away. Ask Q1–Q6; tick ✓ for each correct answer.

The six questions

Q1 What is the main message of this poster?*Expected: Being heard leads to change: speak, listen, act together.***Q2 What is the 2026 theme line written on it?***Expected: “Lived experiences heard: real voices, real change.” (close wording is fine)***Q3 Name one thing it asks you to do.***Expected: Any one: join the conversation, check in on a friend, offer peer support, challenge stigma.***Q4 What does the picture show, from left to right?***Expected: Someone unheard → a bridge of conversation → being included at the table.***Q5 (Leaflet) Where can someone find support?***Expected: Any one: someone you trust, university counselling, 16263, 999.***Q6 Is anything confusing, upsetting, stigmatising or hard to read?***Expected: Write the answer word for word in the comments column.*

Tally sheet

#	Student (initials)	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q5	Comments (Q6)
1							
2							
3							
4							
5							
6							
7							
8							
9							
10							
Correct out of 10		/10	/10	/10	/10	/10	Main changes needed:

Decision rule: if fewer than **8 out of 10** answer a question correctly, revise that part (bigger text, clearer picture or simpler words). Then show it to the course teacher before the final print.